

Guidelines for Portfolio Preparing

Presented by AKD Thashila Yohani & Ravindu Panditharathna

University College of Batangala



Why a Strong Portfolio Matters



Your Professional Story

Your portfolio is your professional story — it showcases skills, creativity, and growth.



Beyond the Resume

Employers and institutions prioritize portfolios over resumes alone.



Opens Doors

A well-crafted portfolio opens doors to interviews, internships, and job offers.

Understand Your Audience & Purpose

Tailor your portfolio to the industry or role you're targeting.

Research specific requirements from employers or educational institutions.



For example: Creative fields want visuals; corporate roles may prefer project summaries.

Select Your Best Work – Quality Over Quantity



Showcase Your Strongest

Include 5 to 10 strongest projects or pieces that demonstrate your skills and versatility.



Demonstrate Variety

Showcase a variety of techniques, media, or problem-solving approaches.



Capture Attention Early

Start with your most impressive work to grab attention immediately.

Show Your Creative Process

Include sketches, drafts, or concept notes to reveal how ideas evolved.

Employers value insight into your problem-solving and critical thinking.



Example: Before/after images or step-by-step project development.

Organize Your Portfolio Logically

Cover Page Essentials

Start with your name, contact info, and portfolio title.

Categorize Your Work

Group work by theme, medium, or chronology to tell a clear story.

Add Contextual Descriptions

Add brief descriptions or captions explaining each piece's context and your role.

Presentation & Format Tips

Use high-resolution images or clean digital files (PDF preferred).

Keep file size manageable (under 5MB recommended for digital submissions).



For physical portfolios, ensure neat mounting and professional appearance.

Include Supporting Documents When Relevant

Personal Statement

A personal statement or career objective tailored to your goals.

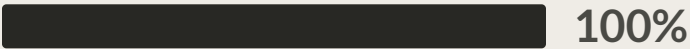
Updated CV

An updated CV highlighting relevant experience and skills.

Academic Records

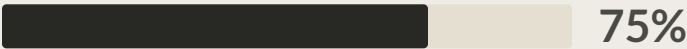
Academic transcripts or certificates if requested.

Common Pitfalls to Avoid



Overloading

Overloading with too many pieces or irrelevant work.



Poor Quality

Poor image quality or inconsistent formatting.



Lack of Narrative

Lack of clear narrative or explanation of your work.



Final Thoughts & Next Steps

- Regularly update your portfolio to reflect new skills and achievements.
- Seek feedback from mentors, peers, or CareerOne advisors.
- Your portfolio is a living document — make it uniquely yours and confidently share it!